School Closure Report

Rose City Park Elementary School

Date: 11/17/2026

School Closure Process
The PPS Board of Education determines whether schools will be closed. Board determination on school closures is based on the Superintendent's recommendation. The School Initiation & Closure policy (6.10.030-P) requires that the Superintendent's recommendation be accompanied by a School Closure Report.

If you have questions about this process or this report, please contact:

Dr. Jon Franco, Senior Chief of Operations
Margaret Calvert, Executive Director of School Planning and Modernization
501 N Dixon, Portland, OR 97227 | 503-916-2000

1. School Profile

School Name
Rose City Park Elementary School

Administrator
Sheryll Orbase

Location
2334 NE 57th Ave, Portland OR

Grade levels served
K-5

1a. School Description

Rose City Park Elementary School is a Northeast Portland K–5 school offering neighborhood instruction and Vietnamese Dual Language Immersion, where students spend half the day learning with a Vietnamese-speaking teacher and half with an English-speaking teacher. To continue the language pathway, students then graduate to Roseway Heights Middle School and onto McDaniel High School. Built in 1912, Rose City Park has three levels and 27 classrooms. Approximately 390 students are enrolled at Rose City Park for the 2026-2027 school year.

1b. Financial Impact

The primary financial benefit of consolidating elementary schools and programs is to align school capacity and operating costs with enrollment, allowing PPS to concentrate limited resources in fewer, more efficiently resourced schools. Combining school communities can reduce duplicative school-level administrative and operating expenses, improve building utilization, and support more efficient staffing and program delivery. These consolidations are intended to generate ongoing savings while supporting strong core instructional programs and student services.

If the school remains open, the projected cost per student for the 2028/2029 school year is: $19,741. (This is calculated using projected FY28 compensation levels and current staffing practices, which could change in the near future due to budget uncertainty.)

If the school is closed in 2028, the projected overall savings is $898,472. This includes savings from Administrative, Custodial, and Office staffing, 80% of utilities and includes one-time cost of teacher moves. We anticipate ongoing expenses, including 20% of current utility costs and an average annual security cost, if the school were closed and unoccupied.

To accommodate the students who live more than one mile from Scott, PPS anticipates increasing service to Scott from three to four buses/routes. The Transportation Department estimates an additional savings of approximately $126,000. The proposed change would reduce the total number of buses serving the closing and receiving schools, resulting in transportation cost savings. Students in the Vietnamese Dual Language Immersion (DLI) program would move to Vestal K-5. Students in the VDLI program would be offered transportation with their DLI peers.

Transportation and Safe Routes to School planning will identify needed supports for safe arrival and dismissal, including walking and biking improvements, crossing supports, or traffic circulation changes.

1c. Student Enrollment

Table 1. Projected enrollment over the next five years, if school remains open:

School Year	2027-28	2028-29	2029-30	2030-31	2031-32
Students Enrolled	391	366	368	364	370

History of Requested and Actual Transfers
During the 2024-2025, 2025-2026, and 2026-2027 school years, 132 students requested transfers into Rose City Park, and 85 enrolled through an approved transfer. During the same period, 136 students residing within the school's attendance area requested transfers to other schools, and 31 enrolled elsewhere through an approved transfer.

Projected enrollment remains above the district's 360 student threshold and does not, on its own, indicate that the school would be unable to maintain stable staffing, programming, or essential student supports. The closure was considered within the broader district context, including opportunities to improve facility utilization and condition, align resources with student needs, and sustain well-resourced schools across the entire district.

2. School Facilities and Student Reassignment

2a. School Description

Built	Building size	Stories	Acres
1912	73,719 sq ft	3	3.7
Building condition	**Gross capacity**	**Functional capacity**	**Cost of school operations**
Poor; FCI 0.12	744 students	609 students	$5,971,122

Gross capacity is the estimated maximum number of students a school can accommodate, calculated by assigning a student capacity to each classroom based on its square footage and summing those capacities:

- Less than 800 square feet: 24 students
- 800–1,000 square feet: 27 students
- More than 1,000 square feet: 30 students

Functional capacity is a practical estimate of the number of students a school can accommodate, calculated by multiplying its gross capacity by the applicable utilization rate. It does not represent maximum occupancy under building code requirements or determine staffing levels.

The cost of school operations includes projected FY28 school-based costs in funds 100 and 200 plus Facilities, Nutrition Services, and Special Education, at the current service level.

Physical Condition of Building, Capital and Environmental Needs
Rose City Park is a multi-story school built in 1912. Facility assessments conducted in 2019–2020 identified plumbing fixtures, most heating and cooling equipment, exhaust fans, the main electrical switchboard, and many distribution panels beyond their typical design lives. The roof hatch and original skylight were also aged and deteriorated. The assessment recorded fire-alarm installation in 2019 and a partially sprinklered building. In addition, Rose City Park has undersized classrooms and a lack of purposely designed special education space.

ADA Accessibility
Rose City Park has an accessible entrance and an elevator.

Building Use
Rose City Park houses K–5 neighborhood instruction and Vietnamese Dual Language Immersion, with student support services and enrichment instruction.

Analysis of current and potential use of the facility, including recommended disposition
Following closure, potential uses of the Rose City Park facility will be evaluated through the district's Building Repurposing process, informed by community engagement, district needs, facility conditions, and financial considerations. This process will consider opportunities to support students and the surrounding community and identify a recommended future use or disposition for Board consideration. Rose City Park was set to receive a full seismic retrofit in 28-29. Closure would provide the opportunity to redistribute those funds to address other high risk building parts.

2b. Student Reassignment

The proposed closure of Rose City Park would move its full neighborhood K–5 boundary to Scott and its Vietnamese Dual Language Immersion program to Vestal in 2028-2029. Vietnamese DLI students would retain the Roseway Heights Middle School pathway. Special Education students receiving Learning Center support would continue to receive support at Scott K–5.

Proposed Attendance Boundary
See attached map.

Transportation options and barriers
Transportation options include walking, biking, family transportation, and school bus service for elementary students who live more than one mile from their neighborhood school; additional students may qualify based on Oregon Department of Education guidelines or individual needs. We do not anticipate any barriers to students getting to school; however, additional bussing may be provided, as needed, for hazard areas within the school attendance boundary.

How will this school location accommodate the reassigned students?
Scott has 27 regular classrooms (and two modular classrooms) and a functional capacity of 633 students. With a combined enrollment of 489, Scott will be able to accommodate the reassigned students. Vestal has 23 regular classrooms (and three modular classrooms) and a functional capacity of 516 students. With a combined enrollment of 444, Vestal will be able to accommodate the reassigned students.

Recommendation
PPS recommends closing Rose City Park Elementary School for the 2028–2029 school year, assigning its full neighborhood K–5 boundary to Scott, and relocating Vietnamese Dual Language Immersion to Vestal. Vietnamese DLI students would retain the Roseway Heights Middle School pathway.

3. Community/Cluster and District Impact Analysis

3a. Cluster Analysis

How will the proposed closure maintain or improve equity of access to schools offering high quality educational choices?
In the 2026-27 school year PPS staffs and supports 56 elementary programs across the district. Eleven of these programs are situated within K-8 campuses. The enrollment of these programs ranges from 160 students to over 550 students. Using the QEM and our system definition of "well-resourced schools" as a guide, we have established an elementary enrollment of 360 as the minimum threshold to be able to staff and support a comprehensive and stable elementary program. Maximizing the number of sites at or above this minimum threshold allows the district to maximize the number of students who experience grade-level classrooms, comprehensive core enrichments, and targeted academic supports. It also maximizes the number of educators who work full-time on one campus and who benefit from regular collaboration with grade- and content-alike colleagues.

By operating fewer elementary schools and spreading current enrollment more evenly across remaining sites, the district can stabilize and offer a more comprehensive and sustainable program at each elementary site.

In recent years, we have used resources from other parts of our system to subsidize elementary programs with low enrollment. Given our current and projected budget shortfalls, we can no longer sustain subsidies for underenrolled sites. As a result, elementary schools have already faced several programmatic and operational constraints:

- Over half of our elementary programs have been forced to place students in multi-grade classrooms;
- Staffing for instructional coaching, academic coaching, and school climate support positions have been reduced;
- Core enrichment teachers that support Arts, PE, and Library/Media instruction have been split across multiple sites, reducing the capacity to have full-school enrichment programs;
- Support staff that help monitor lunch and recess have been reduced, forcing principals to spend much of their time monitoring duty;
- Opportunities for strong teacher collaboration and professional learning have been compromised by multi-grade classrooms and single-strand programs.

If we continue with no rightsizing action, all of these constraints will be compounded in the 2027-2028 school year.

3b. Effects on Other Schools, Enrollment, and Community Access

The proposed merger would affect Scott and Vestal within the Leodis V. McDaniel cluster. Rose City Park's neighborhood students would attend Scott, and its Vietnamese Dual Language Immersion (DLI) program would relocate to Vestal. Enrollment at Scott is projected to change from approximately 500 in 2026-2027 to 324 in 2027-2028 then to 489 in the 2028–2029 school year. In 2027, based on current enrollment projections, there will be two classrooms at each grade level, with blends not required at Scott. All classrooms will be neighborhood English Scholar classrooms. In 2028, enrollment will continue to increase as students from Rose City Park join the Scott community.

Enrollment at Vestal is projected to change from 283 to 444 in 2028-2029. Based on current enrollment projections, this program relocation will result in three to four classrooms at each grade level, with some number of blends likely. These changes would support combined school communities, with opportunities to stabilize staffing and sustain educational programs and student supports while preserving Vietnamese language instruction. Implementation will require coordinated staffing, classroom assignments, and use of shared spaces.

Scott is ready to receive students, as its 2028-2029 projected enrollment is actually less than its current enrollment, with no specific facility upgrades required before their arrival. Vestal requires moderate kitchen upgrades, including double ovens estimated at $27,000, along with appropriate classrooms and instructional resources for the incoming Vietnamese DLI program.

Rose City Park is located approximately 1.5 miles from Scott and 2.3 miles from Vestal. Nearby community resources include Wellington Park near Scott and Montavilla Park and Montavilla Community Center in the broader Vestal area. The proposed change would shift students' daily school activities toward their receiving schools. Transportation options include walking, biking, family transportation, and school bus service for eligible students. Travel distances and potential barriers would vary by home address and receiving-school assignment, with transportation provided for Vietnamese DLI students at Vestal via a hub model for students who attend from multiple neighborhoods. PPS would support school bus service for eligible students who live more than one mile from Scott. Both schools would be able to work with the district Safe Routes to School coordinator to identify appropriate crossing, pedestrian, and bicycle safety measures.

3c. Community Partnerships and Potential Community Impact

Rose City Park partners with Grow Portland, which teaches a gardening class during the school day. Closure could affect student access to this programming. Rose City Park students are projected to transition to Vestal, which does not offer Grow Portland. Opportunities for the partnership to continue, relocate, or adapt include bringing the program to Vestal if the school has a garden that can support it. Services requiring alternatives or further coordination include confirming whether Vestal has a school garden; if it does not, the program may be relocated to another school that does. Additional community impacts include a possible gap in gardening instruction for transitioning students, with proposed responses including working with Vestal's building leaders and school community to determine student needs and readiness to support this partnership.

Rose City partners with a child care provider serving approximately 60 students and families. Relocating these students to Scott, which currently serves approximately 50 students, and

Vestal, which serves approximately 52, could bring combined enrollment across the three schools to approximately 162 students. This transition requires careful planning to ensure both receiving schools have sufficient, appropriately licensed space, staffing, and operational capacity to accommodate additional students without compromising existing programs. Additionally, 13 families across the three schools currently receive ERDC (Employment Related Day Care) assistance, including three at Rose City, nine at Scott, and one at Vestal. These families will need proactive coordination to prevent interruptions in child care subsidies. We ask that all affected providers and school administrations be included in early planning discussions to determine how students will be divided, assess available space and resources, and develop a transition plan that preserves continuity of care, protects existing programs, and minimizes disruptions for all families.

Rose City Park partners with Immigrant and Refugee Community Organization (IRCO) to operate its SUN Community School, providing community-based services and wraparound family supports through braided funding among Portland Public Schools, Multnomah County, and the City of Portland. IRCO provides free extended-day enrichment opportunities, including art, chess club, tennis, Vietnamese tutoring, ukulele, student leadership, and LEGO activities, as well as free summer day camps, access to a food pantry and other basic-needs resources, and culturally and linguistically responsive programming supported by staff who reflect and understand the student population.

SUN also serves as an important connection point for students and families to access individualized support, community resources, enrichment opportunities, and connections to housing, utility assistance, and other social services. Closure could affect student and family access to established relationships with SUN staff, enrichment providers, and community resources, as well as require adjustments to programming locations, partner operations, and access to existing supports.

Opportunities for partnerships to continue include transitioning students and services to Vestal and Scott, both of which operate SUN Community Schools. Vestal is operated by IRCO, creating an opportunity to maintain greater organizational continuity, preserve existing service connections, and coordinate student and family transitions within an established service system.

Scott is operated by Latino Network, meaning students and families transitioning there would experience a change in lead agency. Although SUN services would remain available, this transition may require families to establish new relationships with SUN staff and navigate different community partnerships, programming, and family-support coordination.

Services requiring further coordination include assessing Vestal and Scott's capacity to accommodate additional students and service needs, coordinating SUN staffing and program resources, maintaining access to existing enrichment partners and basic-needs supports, transferring family referrals and individualized support needs, and ensuring students can continue receiving wraparound services without interruption.

Additional community impacts include the potential disruption of trusted relationships with IRCO staff, changes in how families access culturally and linguistically responsive community resources, and the loss of established neighborhood connections, with proposed responses including coordinating with IRCO, Latino Network, and receiving-school leadership to develop a transition plan, establish warm handoffs between agencies, identify staffing and resource

needs, communicate changes with families, and prioritize continuity of services and student participation in existing programs. Particular consideration should be given to supporting families transitioning to Scott to ensure they maintain access to culturally responsive services and community resources despite the change in lead agency.

Any future community use of the facility would be considered through the Building Repurposing process.

3d. Operational Plan & Boundary Map

If approved, the closure would take effect in 2028, with students assigned to Scott Elementary under the proposed boundaries shown in the attached boundary map and students in the Vietnamese DLI program assigned to Vestal Elementary School.

Operational Implementation Plan

Timeline*	Action
January 2028	Establish school transition teams and school-specific implementation plans. Verify student enrollment. Share principal assignments with communities.
February 2028	Develop staffing plans and confirm initial staff assignments. Identify and prioritize building improvements, equipment, and technology needs.
March 2028	Identify initial classroom assignments and develop school-specific moving schedules, distribute packing supplies, and begin records transfers.
April 2028	Begin packing and sorting materials not needed for daily instruction. Finalize plans for building improvements and technology setup.
May 2028	Confirm summer moving and building-work schedules. Continue packing and prepare materials for transportation and other operational services for receiving schools.
June 2028	Complete teacher packing. Begin school moves after the school year ends and carry out scheduled building improvements.
July 2028	Continue school moves and building improvements. Install furniture, equipment, and technology at receiving schools.
August 2028	Complete scheduled moves by mid August. Finish cleaning, classroom setup, and technology testing.
September 2028	Monitor school operations and address remaining transition needs. Complete closing-building inventories.

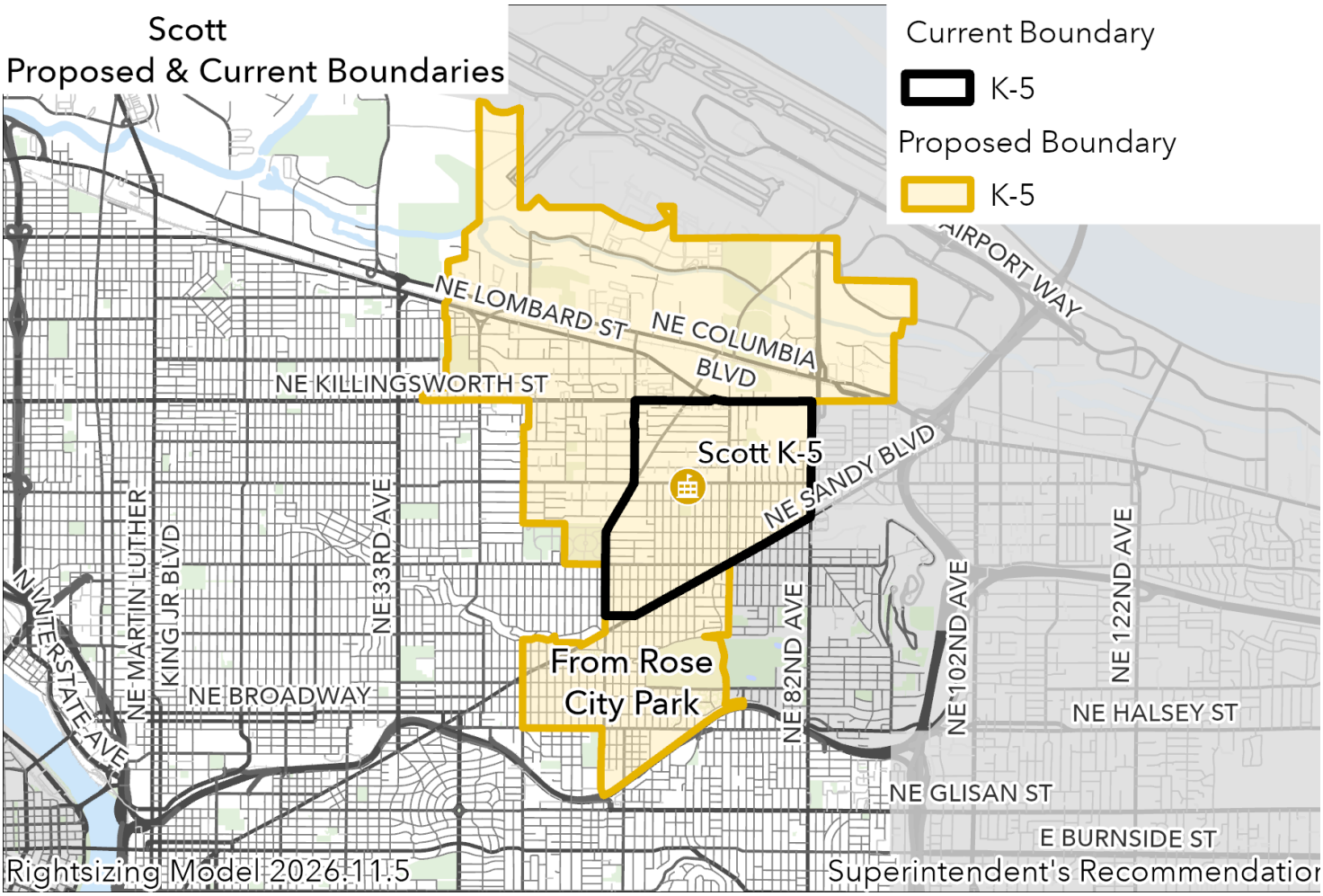
**Subject to change*

Review and Approval

This report has been reviewed by appropriate district staff.

Superintendent Signature

Date


Scott
Proposed & Current Boundaries
Current Boundary
K-5
Proposed Boundary
K-5
NE LOMBARD ST
NE COLUMBIA BLVD
AIRPORT WAY
NE KILLINGSWORTH ST
Scott K-5
NE SANDY BLVD
NE MARTIN LUTHER KING JR BLVD
NE 33RD AVE
N INTERSTATE AVE
NE BROADWAY
From Rose City Park
NE 82ND AVE
NE 102ND AVE
NE 122ND AVE
NE HALSEY ST
NE GLISAN ST
E BURNSIDE ST
Rightsizing Model 2026.1.1.5
Superintendent's Recommendation